



the basic
argument



allowable
evils

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

1. If God exists, then God is omnipotent.
2. If something is omnipotent, it can do anything.
3. If God exists, then God can do anything. (1,2)
4. If God exists, then God is wholly good.
5. If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much evil as it can.
6. If God exists, then God eliminates as much evil as God can. (4,5)
7. If God exists, then God eliminates all evil. (3,6)
8. If God exists, then there is no evil. (7)
9. Some evil exists.

C. God does not exist. (8,9)

We initially presented the argument as **reductio ad absurdum** - 'reduction to absurdity.' This is a style of argument in which you show that a collection of claims imply an obvious falsehood -- like that there is evil and is not evil -- with the aim of demonstrating that at least one claim in the collection must be false.

But we can also present the argument as, at left, a straightforward argument for the conclusion that God does not exist.

THE ARGUMENT FROM EVIL

it can do anything.

1. If God exists, then God is

2. If something is important,

wholly good.

do anything. (1,2)

it always initiates as much

eliiiiiiiataiiiiii

4. If God exists, then God is



6. If God exists, then God

3. If God exists, then God can

5. If something is wholly good,

9: nine exists.

avis.avis.it.avis.it.



7. If God exists, then God

elinites all envil.(3,6)

no evil in (7)

C. God does not exist. (8,9)

Goodman. (4, 5)

8. If God exists, then there is

argument as reduction and absurdum

style of argument in which you

imply an obvious falsehood--like

show that a collection of claims

- 'reduction to absurdity.' This is a

We initially presented the

collusion must be false.

with the aim of demonstrating

that there is evil and is not evil - -

that at least one claim in the

straightforward argument for the

argument as, at left, a

exist.

But we can also present the

conclusion that God does not







any possible

cairibiriing about

is important, it

2: If something

the 1990s, the number of people with a mental health problem has increased by 50% (Mental Health Foundation 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems, and the importance of the role of the community. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help. This approach is based on the idea that people with mental health problems can lead a full and meaningful life, and that they should be given the opportunity to do so. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help.

The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help. This approach is based on the idea that people with mental health problems can lead a full and meaningful life, and that they should be given the opportunity to do so. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help.

The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help. This approach is based on the idea that people with mental health problems can lead a full and meaningful life, and that they should be given the opportunity to do so. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help.

The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help. This approach is based on the idea that people with mental health problems can lead a full and meaningful life, and that they should be given the opportunity to do so. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help.

The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help. This approach is based on the idea that people with mental health problems can lead a full and meaningful life, and that they should be given the opportunity to do so. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help.

The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help. This approach is based on the idea that people with mental health problems can lead a full and meaningful life, and that they should be given the opportunity to do so. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help.

The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help. This approach is based on the idea that people with mental health problems can lead a full and meaningful life, and that they should be given the opportunity to do so. The Department of Health (1999) has identified the need to develop a new approach to mental health care, one that is based on the principles of recovery, empowerment, and self-help.

1. If God exists, then God is

evil as God said. (4,5)

it can do anything.



4. If God exists, then God is

5*. If something is wholly good,





no point less evi1. (7)

elinitatesas much printless

2. If something is on it,

(3,6)

elinites all point less vii.

C. God does not exist. (8,9)

9*. Some principles exist.

it always initiates as much

prints even as it can.

8. If God exists, then there is

the basic
argument



**allowable
evils**

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated



9*. Some points less

evildoers.

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "what is omnipotence?" is written in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font.

what is
omnipotence?

There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.

So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



as in the visit card.

5. If something is wholly

good, it always reminds



**allowable
evils**

The argument appears to be

who believes that God does

valid, so it looks like anyone

argument's independent

exist must reject one of the

premises.

THE ARGUMENT FROM EVIL

5. If something is wholly good,

9. Since we exist:

avis.avis.avis.